



01 Reflection

Starring ...

Written by Pum van de Koppel

ACT 1

I depart from my home to attend an event at the Artistic Research Studio, and arrive in IJburg a bit earlier to help with setting up the space. There I meet Nelli Molfenter (later as "Big Movie Star") and Ian Marquez Garcia (later as "Organ Player"). They introduce each other. The "Big Movie Star" remarks that she is German upon which the "Organ Player" said that you couldn't hear an accent at all. I speak to them a bit more in my Dutch accent and then leave them to their rehearsal. I go backstage to help with making dinner for the attendees. My script for the evening is asking "Would you like some soup?". After the guests trickle in, socialise with the celebrity cats ('Blue' and 'White') and have some of this soup, we all shuffle chairs to the downstairs around the improvised podium. The

ambient lights turn off and the
spotlight turns on.



ACT 2

In the negative of the bright light
we all sit around, in an embrace
with the stage.

The performance has an elaborate
script with multiple scenes and
characters: a famous actress "Big
Movie Star" slowly loses herself
when the movie industry transitions
from the 'silent movies' to the
'talking pictures'. The "Big Movie
Producer" and the "Agent" push her
around, tell her to sing, to put on
her 'Big Smile'. She refuses to use
her voice because its absence
warranted the only agency she had
left on the screen. Throughout the
scenes the leading character looks
to interpret the world herself,
instead of being interpreted. In one
scene she is spinning around and
around, blurring the world she
inhabits. In another, where she is
lying on a hospital bed after a
psychotic episode, she notices a
stranger standing perfectly
symmetrical in the frame of the open
door.

Intermezzo - a few days

A French guy (Derrida) philosophised that to completely welcome a guest, must also mean the possibility that the host has to nullify themselves, 'Absolute Hospitality'. I hung around on the internet and clicked on a YouTube video about it (by 'Philosophy for Where We Find Ourselves'). The American guy in the video quotes him: "Language itself is already hospitality".



I overhear someone from the audience wishing to have read the script along, maybe feeling like they missed out on something, an understanding.

The performance ended.

I forgot exactly how, but remember a metaphor with a moth. In the script as well as on stage it appeared, spinning and circling in between the light and the darkness.

I do come here more often, seated in corners and shadows.

Here we remain more characters than actors.

What if hospitality must also mean the possibility for the guests to occlude themselves?

The cats (from Act 1) don't speak

English. Neither do they have an accent.



An exhibition with curtains.
Just like the evening oscillated
from the strong diction of the "Big
Movie Star" to the moody soundtrack
by the "Organ Player" and back, I
navigate between different modes of
relating towards the theatrical
space and towards the others.
Overhearing the breathing of a
neighbour in the audience, or
retreating in my own thoughts.
Noticing the glimmering spotlight
reflected in the eyes of the
performer. A guest appearance of a
moth, a phone in my pocket. Here in
the east of Amsterdam Oost, the
mythical New York City of the "Big
Movie Star" feels very close by.

Sitting here with too much soup, I
am left to digest words. An
abundance of words (of New York
slang) and a lack of. An
acknowledging of strangers,
strangeness. Emancipation without
words.



Pum van de Koppel is infiltrating,
constructing, mixing, painting,
making websites, glueing,
politicizing, cycling, attempting,
looking out of the window,
structuring, cuddling, spilling,
